

S.Swathi vs S.Harihara Gowtham on 7 December, 2022

Author: S.M.Subramaniam

Bench: S.M.Subramaniam

Tr.

IN THE HIGH COURT OF JUDICATURE AT MADRAS

DATED : 07.12.2022

CORAM

THE HONOURABLE MR.JUSTICE S.M.SUBRAMANIAM

Tr.C.M.P.No.651 of 2022

and

C.M.P.No.11121 of 2022

S.Swathi

...

Vs.

S.Harihara Gowtham

...

Prayer: Transfer CMP is filed under Section 24 of the Civil Procedure Code, to withdraw the transfer the above HMOP No. 281 of 2021 from file of the Hon'ble Sub Court, Devakottai to Family Court at Chennai

For Petitioner : Mrs. V.Karpagavalli

For Respondent : Mr. R.Racha Pandian

ORDER

The petition for transfer is filed to withdraw the transfer the above HMOP No. 281 of 2021 from the file of the Hon'ble Sub Court, Devakottai to Family Court at Chennai.

<https://www.mhc.tn.gov.in/judis>

2. The marriage between the petitioner and the respondent was solemnised on 31.08.2020 as per the Hindu Rites and Rituals. One female child was born from and out of wedlock between the petitioner and the respondent. Now the petitioner is residing along with her parents at Chennai. More so, the respondent has filed the petition on HMOP.No.281 of 2021 for restitution of conjugal rights and therefore, the petitioner is not in a position to contest the case by travelling all along from Chennai to Devakottai.

3. The principles regarding transfer petitions, more specifically in the matters of matrimonial cases, are well settled through the three decisions of the High Court of Madras, in the following cases:-

(i) The Hon'ble Division Bench of the High Court of Madras in W.A.No.1181 of 2009, dated 09.07.2010, wherein in paragraphs-21 and 22, it has been observed as under:-

“21. The domicile or citizenship of the opposite party is immaterial in a case like this. In case the marriage was solemnized under Hindu Law marital relationship is governed by the provisions of the Hindu Marriage Act. Therefore, Section 19 has to be <https://www.mhc.tn.gov.in/judis> given a purposeful interpretation. It is the residence of the wife, which determines the question of jurisdiction, in case the proceeding was initiated at the instance of the wife.

22. While considering a provision like Section 19 (iii-a) of the Hindu Marriage Act, the objects and reasons which prompted the parliament to incorporate such a provision has also to be taken note of. Sub Clause (iii-a) was inserted in Section 19 with a specific purpose. Experience is the best teacher. The Government found the difficulties faced by women in the matter of initiation of matrimonial proceedings. The report submitted by the Law Commission as well as National Commission for Women, underlying the need for such amendment so as to enable the women to approach the nearest jurisdictional court to redress their matrimonial grievances, were also taken note of by the Government. Therefore such a beneficial provision meant for the women of our Country should be given a meaningful interpretation by Courts.”

(ii) In yet another case in Tr.CMP.Nos.138 and 139 of 2006, dated 30.08.2006, the High Court of Madras has considered the following judgments of Hon'ble Supreme Court of India:-

<https://www.mhc.tn.gov.in/judis> “(1) In the case of Mona Aresh Goel vs. Aresh Satya Goel [(2000) 9 SCC 255], when the wife pleaded that she was unable to bear the traveling expenses and even to travel alone and stay at Bombay, the Supreme Court ordered transfer of proceedings.

(2) In the case of Geeta Heera vs. Harish Chander Heera [(2000) 10 SCC 304], the Hon'ble Supreme Court has held that where the petitioner's wife has pleaded lack of money, the same has to be considered.

(3) In the case of Lalita A.Ranga vs. Ajay Champalal Ranga [(2000) 9 SCC 355], the wife has filed a petition to transfer the proceedings initiated by the husband for divorce, at Bombay.

The place of residence of the wife was at Jaipur, Rajasthan. In that case, the petitioner is having a small child and that she pleaded difficulty in going all the way from Jaipur to Bombay to contest the

proceedings from time to time. Considering the distance and the difficulties faced by the wife, the Supreme Court has allowed the transfer petition.

(4) In a decision in Archana Singh vs. Surendra Bahadur Singh [(2005) 12 SCC 395], the wife has sought for transfer of matrimonial proceedings and a divorce petition has been filed by <https://www.mhc.tn.gov.in/judis> the respondent's husband at Baikunthpur to be transferred to Allahabad, where the petitioner's wife was residing, on the ground that it would be difficult for her to undertake such long distance journey, particularly in circumstances, in which she finds that the proceedings under 5 Section 125 Cr.P.C. was already pending before the Family Court, Allahabad. Considering the difficulties faced by the wife and also the long distance journey, the Honourable Supreme Court was pleased to order transfer of the proceedings to Allahabad.”

(iii) In a decision made in TR.CMP(MD)No.108 of 2010, dated 03.03.2011, the Madurai Bench of Madras High Court, wherein in paragraph-18, it has been observed as below:-

“18. It is true that section 19 of the Hindu Marriage Act, has been amended by insertion of proviso of (iii)(a) to section 19. Of Course, this amended section 19(iii)(a) gives special preference to the wife to file a petition or defending the case of the husband before the Court within whose jurisdiction she resides. The intention of the Legislator is to safe-guard the interest and rights of the women, who are being subjected to harassment and cruelty. But this special preference conferred under section 19(iii)(a) of the Hindu <https://www.mhc.tn.gov.in/judis> Marriage Act shall not be used to wreck vengeance on the husband. There must be a justifiable cause to select the jurisdiction of the Court where she resides.”

4. Considering the facts and circumstances, the HMOP No.281 of 2021 pending on the file of the Sub Court, Devakottai, Sivagangai District stands transferred to the Family Court, Chennai. The Sub Court, Devakottai is directed to transmit the case papers to the Family Court, Chennai within a period of four (4) weeks from the date of receipt of a copy of this order and the maintenance case is to be trailed as expeditiously as possible.

5. With the abovesaid directions, the Transfer Civil Miscellaneous Petition stands allowed. However, there shall be no order as to costs.

Consequently, the connected miscellaneous petition is closed.

07.12.2022 Skr/Jeni Index : Yes Speaking order <https://www.mhc.tn.gov.in/judis> To

1.The Judge, Sub Court, Devakottai.

2.The Judge, Family Court, Chennai.

<https://www.mhc.tn.gov.in/judis> S.M.SUBRAMANIAM, J.

Skr 07.12.2022 <https://www.mhc.tn.gov.in/judis>